

CNC TRAY CAPTURE

one tool, about a minute

1 LAY

Take a capture sheet: the smallest size the tool lies in with a finger's width of magenta all round. Lay the tool FLAT inside the magenta window, on its widest face, as it sits in the drawer, clear of the border. Note its TAG (T0__, from the drawer label).

2 MEASURE

Measure the tool's tallest point above the sheet with the ruler, in mm, as it lies. A bottle on its side is its diameter.

3 SHOOT

Stand over the sheet. Phone flat, high enough that the whole sheet is about a third of the screen, all four corner squares showing. The bigger and rounder the tool, the higher the phone. No flash, no lamp shadow. Do not move the tool.

4 SUBMIT

Open the form "CNC tray capture": tag, height in mm, the photo. Done. The software reads the corner squares to know which paper you used and takes the tool's own outline out of the magenta. The tray regenerates; a rejected sheet comes back with one line saying why.

WHEN NOT TO PHOTOGRAPH

IT DOES NOT FIT THE WINDOW

Take a bigger sheet: LETTER, then TABLOID. Nothing that will not lie in a drawer gets a pocket, so nothing bigger than TABLOID needs a sheet.

IT WILL NOT LIE FLAT, OR IT SHINES

A tool that rocks or stands on a knob throws its outline: prop it level with a scrap of card. Chrome reflects the magenta and can lose an edge: turn the sheet under the light and shoot again. Look at the preview the software posts back.

One tool per sheet. Never a hand in the window, never a tool on its edge, never a lamp or a flash throwing a hard shadow.

Sheets and the ruler live in Drawer 1. Print in colour at 100%: the bar at the bottom must measure 100mm.